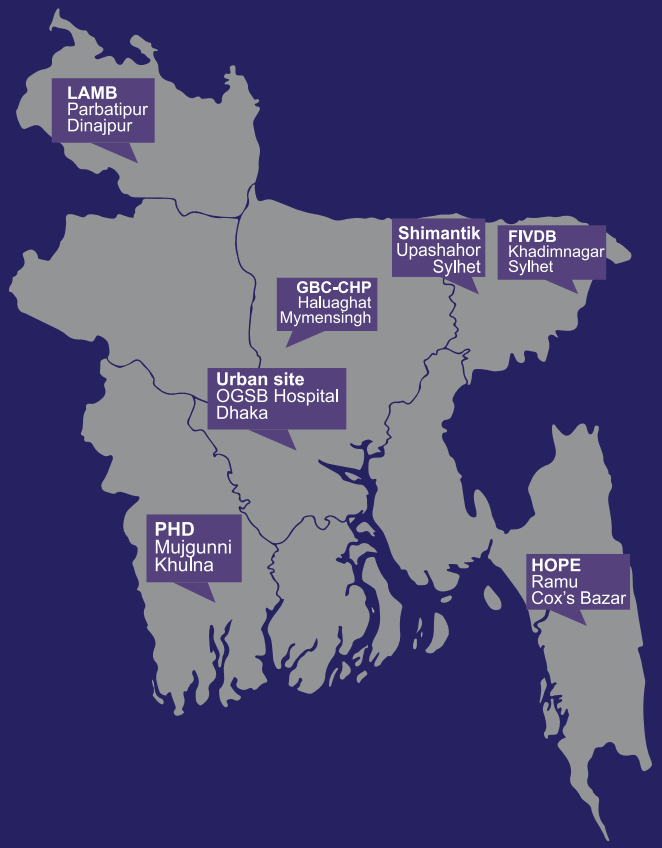
Why we are different?

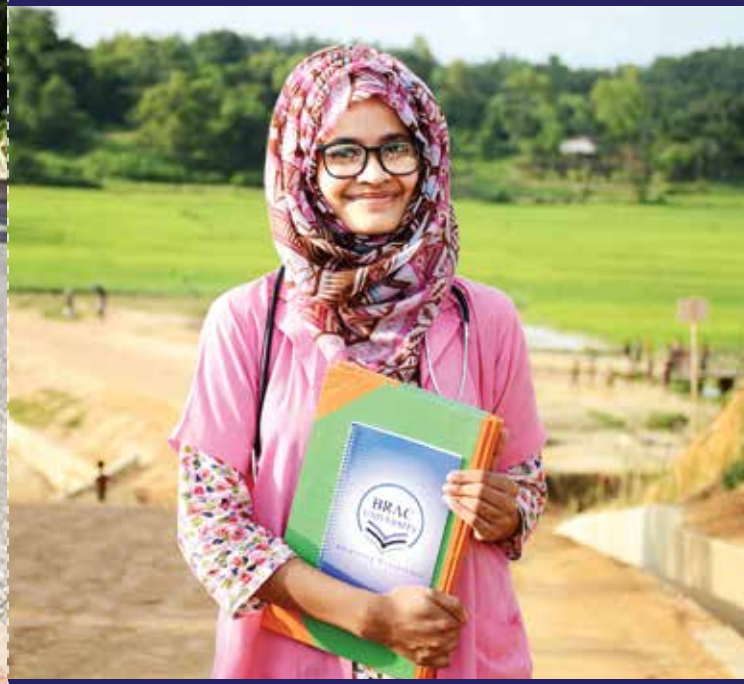
- Community engagement during studentship including health fairs in the community and school premises
- Proficiency in English
- Supervised round the clock clinical practice
- Availability of counsellor who grooms the students
- Student Welfare Committee (SWC) in every academic site
- 30% of students receive free studentship



Hub and Spoke Model

BRAC University follows an innovative 'Hub and Spoke' model to simultaneously deliver the course in the seven academic sites through partnering with experienced local NGOs.

Developing Midwives Project (DMP)
BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health
68 Shahid Tajuddin Ahmed Sharani, 5th Floor (Level - 6)
icddr,b, Building, Mohakhali, Dhaka 1212, Bangladesh
Phone: 880-2-9827501-4, Fax: 880-2-58810383
Website: http://sph.bracu.ac.bd/index.php/midwifery2



MIDWIFERY EDUCATION PROGRAMME

BRAC JAMES P GRANT SCHOOL OF PUBLIC HEALTH (JPGSPH)
BRAC UNIVERSITY

Context

To achieve the SDG goal 3 by 2030, the maternal mortality ratio needs to be reduced to 70 per 100,000 live births and neonatal death rate to be reduced to 12 per 1000 live births. Government of Bangladesh (GoB) continues to prioritize quality maternal and newborn care services in the recently started fourth Health Population & Nutrition Sector Development Plan (HPNSDP) for 2017-2022. The updated Maternal Health Strategy also highlights the need to increase provision of ANC, PNC, NVD, emergency obstetric care, new-born care and family planning services through skilled providers. An estimated 21,000 competent midwives are needed in health facilities as well as in communities, to meet the national targets.

Midwifery Education in BRAC JPGSPH BRAC University

To develop competent and compassionate midwives and to increase their usage for maternal health services, particularly in under-served rural areas in Bangladesh, BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health (JPGSPH), BRAC University (BRACU) started Developing Midwives Project (DMP) in 2012 with funding from the UK Government. After completing the first phase in September 2016, BRAC University started its second phase with DMP. Partnering with seven NGOs at different parts of Bangladesh, DMP gave special emphasis on ethnic minority and marginalized communities since its beginning.

The course specifically prioritize that mothers are enabled to avail a respectful maternity care from the graduate midwives working in their community.

The programme offers

One course coordinator at each academic site with a bunch of faculty members deliver the lessons in the academic sites. The faculty receive refresher training every six months. Students have access to well-equipped skill lab, computer lab, library and recreation facilities. Balanced diet is served at the dormitories. Midwifery Education Team (MET) coordinates with all the academic sites and continuously monitors them to ensure same standard of education. Student Welfare Committee sits every month with elected student leaders, the counsellor and designated faculty to discuss academic, logistic and any other issue of the students.

The course and the curriculum

DMP offers a 3-year diploma course with a midwifery curriculum which follows the standards set by the International Confederation of Midwives (ICM) and endorsed by the Bangladesh Nursing & Midwifery Council (BNMC). The curriculum is of 155 credits, which consists 40% theoretical and 60% practical hours. The three years course is divided into six semesters and consist of different modules. There are also six English language module supported by BRAC Institute of Language (BIL). In several modules students have to engage in the community. Community Engagement for Graduate Midwives (CEGM) is another aspect of this diploma programme which makes BRACU midwifery education different from other institutions. The Midwifery Education Team (MET) is responsible for preparing, revising and timely dissemination of academic calendars, modules and clinical equipment.

Admission criteria

Aligned with the GoB admission standards, BRACU allows young women who have completed 12 years of education (up to HSC or equivalent) and have secured a minimum of 2.5 GPA, in both HSC and SSC level are eligible for the written admission test. When they are successful in written exam they appear for viva. Viva board consisting of a team of three, looks at her attitude, economic capacity, wellness etc.

Graduation requirements:

- 40 Normal Vaginal Delivery (NVD)
- 40 Newborn Care
- 100 Antenatal care
- 100 Postnatal Care
- 100 Neonatal Care
- 25 Family Planning method distribution

Midwife-Led Care Centre (MLC)

Midwife-Led Care Centre (MLC) is another significant initiative of DMP. In an effort to provide quality midwifery-led maternity services to the community and to place the students in a centre to learn midwifery a 24/7 maternity centre led and operated by midwives has been established. One is situated in Mirpur, Dhaka and another in collaboration with Charikata Union Health & Family Welfare Centre (UH&FWC) of Jaintiapur, Sylhet. The MLCs are promoting the alternative birth positions, pain relief exercises to make ease the normal vaginal delivery. These innovative endeavours has contributed to huge patient flow. Moreover, this model centre enables the midwifery students to learn how to provide professional midwifery services, and at the same time, promote midwifery professions to the community people.

Our achievements so far

A. 1059 Students enrolled
B. 579 midwives graduated
C. 399 BNMC Licensed midwives
D. 161 posted by GoB already
E. 164 BRAC University Midwife Graduates are serving in Rohingya Refugee Camps with confidence.